

component of successful Liverpool teams — and added more firepower up front. “I am coming to a club that Jurgen left in a good place,” Slot acknowledged in his first interview with *liverpoolfc.com*.

This team had spent 12 weeks at the top of the table the previous season before crumbling in the second half to finish third. Slot, who had coached Feyenoord to Eredivisie success, was entrusted with implementing his methods and philosophy to help take Liverpool to the next level.

‘Football-obsessed’ was how Trent Alexander-Arnold described him. Several players also pointed out his attention to detail, which made a crucial difference.

Before he walked into the AXA Training Centre in Kirkby, Slot had already analysed Liverpool’s matches from the previous season, including training sessions, to better understand his new players.

“Just before we started the season, he showed us why we didn’t win the league the year before,” said centre-back Ibrahima Konate. “[There were]

some details; he said if we improve on those, we have a big chance to win the league.”

But there were other matters too, beyond the Dutchman’s control. In the transfer market, Liverpool failed to land a defensive midfielder, with injury-prone forward Federico Chiesa being the sole last-minute arrival.

There was also a massive cloud hanging over the futures of its three biggest players — Mohamed Salah, Virgil van Dijk and Alexander-Arnold — all in the final year of their contracts.

To address the defensive midfield issue, Slot moved Ryan Gravenberch — who had little experience playing as the lone No. 6 before this season — into the role. The Netherlands international has been ever-present in the midfield three, complementing Alexis Mac Allister and Dominik Szoboszlai.

Gravenberch has made the most interceptions among midfielders in the league, while Mac Allister ranks fourth for tackles. Szoboszlai provided the link between defence and attack,

BEST PLAYERS



Most Goals: M. Salah (28)

Most Assists: M. Salah (18)

Most Passes: V. Van Dijk (2260)

Most Tackles: A. Mac Allister (95)

Most Interceptions: R. Gravenberch (53)

CLUB STATFILE



Goals: 80 (1st)

Shots: 582 (1st)

Shot-creating actions: 1049 (1st)

Possession: 57.8 (3rd)

Goals Against: 32 (2nd)

Shots on Target Against: 109 (2nd)

Cleansheets: 14 (1st)

Goals from counter-attack: 14 (1st)

